



TSA Gear Checklist

For camera & production equipment flying with the team

Lithium Batteries & Power Banks

- Spare batteries and power banks packed in carry-on only

Never in checked bags - fire risk in the cargo hold.

- Every spare battery is under 100Wh

No quantity limit at that size for personal/production use.

- Any 100-160Wh batteries (large cinema camera batts, big power banks) - airline approval confirmed in advance, max 2 spares

Call/check the airline's battery policy before the trip.

- Nothing over 160Wh packed

Not permitted in passenger baggage at all, carry-on or checked.

- Battery terminals taped or capped, or batteries in individual pouches/cases

Prevents shorting against other metal gear in the bag.

- Batteries installed inside camera bodies/gimbals - camera powered off

Installed batteries can travel in checked bags if the device is off and protected; loose ones cannot.

- Power banks kept out of the overhead bin on the flight itself, within reach

Several airlines now require this - check the specific carrier's current policy.

Cameras, Lenses & Storage Media

- Camera bodies and lenses - fine in carry-on or checked

Carry-on strongly recommended for anything fragile or expensive.

- Memory cards and hard drives (SSD/HDD) - carry-on preferred

Avoids extreme temperature/pressure exposure in cargo, and keeps footage with you.

- Chargers and dummy-battery AC adapters

Allowed in carry-on or checked.

Tripods, Monopods & Stands

- **Small/compact tripods and monopods - carry-on or checked**

Generally fine as long as they fit easily in the bag.

- **Full-size professional tripods with thick/long legs - packed in checked baggage**

Screening officer discretion applies at the checkpoint - thick legs can read as a potential weapon.

- **Light stands, C-stands, sandbags - checked baggage**

Not TSA-restricted items, but too large/heavy for carry-on regardless.

Drones

- **Drone body - carry-on preferred (checked is allowed)**

Carry-on avoids rough handling and keeps it out of extreme cargo-hold temps.

- **Spare drone batteries - same lithium rules as camera batteries: carry-on only, under 100Wh, terminals protected**

See Batteries section above.

- **FAA drone registration confirmed current for any drone over 0.55 lbs**

TSA screens the device; FAA governs whether you can legally fly it once you land.

- **Destination airspace/permits checked if flying at the shoot location**

Especially relevant near airports, national parks, or private property.

Tools & Sharp Items

- **Multitools with a knife blade of any length - checked baggage only**

Not permitted in carry-on regardless of blade length.

- **Multitools with only scissors under 4" - carry-on OK**

Blade-only multitools still need to go checked.

- **Tools 7" or shorter (screwdrivers, small wrenches, etc.) - carry-on OK**

Anything longer than 7", and all power tools, must be checked.

- **Gaffer tape, cable ties, clamps - no restriction**

Fine in carry-on or checked; just budget the weight.

- **Any blades/sharp edges in checked bags sheathed or wrapped**

Protects baggage handlers and screeners.

Liquids, Gels & Aerosols (styling/talent kits)

- Carry-on liquids (hairspray, makeup, adhesives) at 3.4oz/100ml or less per container

Standard 3-1-1 rule: one quart-size bag, one bag per passenger.

- Larger bottles of the same packed in checked baggage instead

No size limit once it's in checked luggage.

Day-Of Reminders

- Arrive early - production kits take longer to screen

Cases full of cables, batteries, and metal gear routinely get a manual bag check.

- Keep all spare batteries and drone batteries accessible for inspection

Screeners may ask to see them separately.

- Double-check the specific airline's policy, not just TSA's

Airlines can be stricter than the TSA baseline (battery counts, overhead-bin rules, etc.) - this has been changing often in 2026.

This is a general planning checklist, not legal advice - TSA and airline rules change frequently (several already updated in 2026). Always verify current requirements at [tsa.gov/travel/security-screening/whatcanibring](https://www.tsa.gov/travel/security-screening/whatcanibring) and with the specific airline before a shoot.